Zerodha Coin SIP case: Part 3 interviews and survey

Who to talk to

Talk to people whose first ever mutual fund investment was a SIP, started 1 to 24 months ago, ideally on Coin. Recruit on purpose for people who had a failed instalment or stopped. A random sample would be mostly happy, active investors.

What the discovery engine says about the audience

Signal from the 1,245 tagged posts	What it means for recruiting
70 of the 84 posts about a failed or stuck SIP come from Play Store and App Store reviews, 79 of them from 2023 on, mostly from current investors	People with failures are recent, active app users. Find them among Coin and Kite users, not only on forums
49 of the 63 posts about stopping, pausing or considering it come from Reddit and YouTube; 13 are from people who already stopped	Stoppers talk in communities. Reddit and investing groups are where to find them
133 posts are from people about to start, and their top worry is setting up (37 posts)	Recent starters remember set-up best. Include some who started in the last 3 months
Age is stated in only 20 posts (17 of them under 35); income and money source almost never	The engine can't describe the audience by age or income. The screener and survey must ask

Who qualifies. Their first ever mutual fund investment was a SIP; they started it 1 to 24 months ago; they are not finance professionals.

Who doesn't. People who held funds before their first SIP; anyone working in fund distribution, advice or a fintech (especially Zerodha); people who never completed a SIP set-up.

Quotas

Group	Branch it tests	Interviews (6)	Survey (target 40)
Had at least one failed or missed instalment	B	2	12 or more
Paused or stopped their SIP (one who stopped after a failure, if possible)	C, D	2	10 or more
Started in the last 3 months	A	1	6 or more
Still active, no problems	Comparison group	1	The rest

- **Platform:** at least 4 of 6 interviewees use Coin. The others can use another app as a comparison. The survey takes any app and asks which one.
- **Timing:** at least half started 12 or more months ago, because only they can tell us whether they were active at month 12.
- **Where to recruit:** the same places as the engine's sources. Reddit (r/IndiaInvestments, r/mutualfunds, r/personalfinanceindia), college and workplace groups, LinkedIn, and friends of friends. Reddit users know more than average, so don't fill quotas from Reddit alone.

Screener

Eight short questions, sent as a form before booking anyone. They take about a minute, qualify the person and place them in a quota group. The same questions open the survey.

#	Question	Options	Rule
1	Have you ever invested in a mutual fund?	Yes / No	No → thank and end
2	Was your very first mutual fund investment a SIP?	Yes / No, a one-time investment / Not sure	Only "Yes" qualifies for interviews
3	When did you start your first SIP?	Under 1 month ago / 1–3 months / 4–12 months / 13–24 months / Over 2 years	Interviews: 1–24 months only

#	Question	Options	Rule
4	Which app did you start it on?	Zerodha Coin or Kite / Groww / Paytm Money / ET Money / Bank app / Fund house website / Through a distributor / Other	Count toward the 4-of-6 Coin quota
5	Which best describes that first SIP today?	Still running / Paused / I stopped it / It stopped without me stopping it / Not sure	Places them in a quota group
6	Has an instalment ever not gone through?	Yes / No / Not sure	"Yes" or "Not sure" → failure group
7	Do you work in mutual fund distribution, financial advice or a fintech company?	Yes / No	Yes → exclude
8	Your age range, and your work	Under 22 / 22–25 / 26–30 / 31–35 / Over 35; Salaried / Self-employed / Student / Other	Profile only; fills the gap the engine left

Ask nothing else at this stage: no fund names, amounts or account details.

Survey

A 5-minute form for 30 to 50 people. It asks for an email, then 7 of the 8 screener questions (not the one on working in finance), then the 12 below; every question feeds a number in Part 2 or tests a branch. At 40 responses, a percentage is good to about ±15 points, so read results as direction, not precision.

- **Final survey form that was sent out:** First SIP experiences: a 5-minute survey
- **Response sheet for that form:** First SIP experiences (Responses)

#	Question	Options	Feeds
S1	Roughly how much do your SIPs add up to each month?	Under ₹1,000 / ₹1,000–2,999 / ₹3,000–4,999 / ₹5,000–9,999 / ₹10,000 or more / No SIP running now	Replaces the ₹3,230 average in sizing
S2	How are your instalments paid?	UPI Autopay / Bank mandate (e-NACH) / I pay by hand each time / Not sure	A: does the user know how money moves?
S3	When you set it up, how clear was it how the money would be taken each month?	Very clear / Somewhat clear / Not clear	A
S5	If an instalment ever failed: how did you find out?	App notification / Email or SMS / Saw it in the app myself / Bank message or statement / Found out much later / Never sure	B: awareness
S6	How long after it failed did you find out?	Same day / Within a week / Over a week / Never really found out	B: silent lapses
S7	What did you do next?	Paid it by hand / Waited for next instalment / Fixed the mandate / Contacted support / Paused or deleted the SIP / Nothing	B: recovery
S8	What caused it, as far as you know?	Not enough balance on the date / Mandate or autopay problem / App or payment error / Changed bank / Don't know	B: failure mix
S10	In the month before your SIP's 1-year mark, did an instalment go through?	Yes / No / Not sure / My SIP is less than 13 months old	Self-reported 12-month SIP retention

#	Question	Options	Feeds
S11	If you paused or stopped: what were the main reasons? (Up to two; skip if not)	Needed the money / Returns disappointed me / Market fell / Payments kept failing / It stopped without me deciding / Moved to another app or investment / Someone advised me / Other	C and D: why people stop
S12	Did you know you could pause a SIP instead of stopping it?	Yes, and I used it / Yes, but didn't use it / No	D
S13	What one change would most help you keep your SIP going?	Free text	Ideas for Part 5
S14	Would you be up for a 30-minute chat?	Yes / No	Interview recruiting, using the email given

S4 (days to first instalment) and S9 (SIP date versus income) were dropped to keep the form short. The interviews still cover both.

Screener question 2 (first investment a SIP) replaces the 70% assumption in sizing. Keep the app question (screener 4) and report every number twice: Coin users only, and all apps. The ready-to-send Google Form adds a consent question, and asks "Have you ever started a SIP?" so people without one finish early.

Interview questions

1. Opening (3 min)

1. Thank them, say what it's for (a student product case), and that there are no right answers.
2. Ask for consent to take notes, or to record if they agree, and say recordings are deleted once notes are written.

2. Starting (branch A, 7 min)

1. Take me back to when you started your first SIP. What made you start then?

- Probe: who or what pointed you to it? Why that app?

2. Walk me through setting it up, step by step, as you remember it.
   - Probe: anything confusing? Anything you had to look up?
3. How long until the first instalment went through? How did you know it had?

3. How the money moves (branches A and B, 7 min)

1. How does the money get from your bank to the fund each month?
   - Probe: do you know if it's UPI Autopay, a bank mandate, or paying by hand?
2. When is your SIP date, and when does your salary or income arrive?
   - Probe: how did you pick the date?
3. Do you check anything around the SIP date? What do you look at?

4. Month to month (branch B, 8 min)

1. Has there been a month when something didn't go as expected with your SIP? Tell me about it.
   - Probe: how did you find out, and how long after? What did the app show?
   - Probe: what did you do next: pay by hand, wait, contact support, delete it?
   - Probe: did the bank charge you anything?
2. If nothing went wrong: how would you know if it had?

5. When it changed (branches C and D, 7 min)

Only for people who paused or stopped.

1. Tell me about the moment you paused or stopped. What was going on?
   - Probe: was it a decision, or did it just stop working?
   - Probe: did you know pausing was possible? Did you look at it?
2. What would have needed to be different for you to keep going?

For people still active:

1. Has there been a time you thought about stopping? What kept you going?

6. Close (3 min)

1. If you could change one thing about how SIPs work in your app, what would it be?
2. Anything I should have asked but didn't?
3. Thank them. Ask if they'd try an early version of a fix later (for Part 6 user testing).

Survey results

37 people answered the final form. Failed instalments are common (12 of 37 said yes or not sure) and are more common on Coin (6 of 11 Coin users against 6 of 26 on other apps). Of the 7 who stopped or paused their first SIP, 3 had a failure, but returns and money needs come up more often than failed payments as the reason. Most respondents are experienced investors, so the survey describes people who stayed more than first-timers at risk.

Who answered

- 31 of 37 started their first SIP over a year ago (22 over two years ago); only 6 in the last 12 months.
- 28 of 37 are aged 26 to 30, 30 are salaried, and 21 put ₹10,000 or more a month into SIPs.
- 11 started on Zerodha, 8 through an agent or distributor, 7 on Groww, 7 on a bank app and 4 elsewhere.

Findings by branch

Branch	Finding	What it means
Sizing	First investment was a SIP: 27 of 37 (73%)	Replaces the 70% guess. It sits inside the range, but a survey about SIPs over-recruits SIP investors
Sizing	21 of 37 invest ₹10,000 or more a month	Far above the ₹3,230 industry average: keep the industry figure for sizing
A. Starts well	All 37 found set-up very clear (30) or somewhat clear (7); all know how they pay (19 bank mandate, 17 UPI Autopay, 1 by hand)	No set-up problem in this group, but they are experienced

Branch	Finding	What it means
B. Keeps working	12 of 37 had a failure or aren't sure. Causes: mandate or autopay 5, short balance 4, don't know 2, app or payment error 1. 4 of 12 found out over a week later. 5 fixed the mandate, 3 waited for the next month, 3 paused or deleted the SIP, 1 paid by hand	Failures are frequent and sometimes noticed late
B, Coin only	6 of 11 Coin users against 6 of 26 on other apps. 3 of the 6 Coin cases were mandate problems; 3 found out over a week later	Fits Coin's no-retry rule, but 11 people is too few to conclude anything
C. Wants to continue	5 stopped and 2 paused their first SIP; 3 of the 7 had a failure. Their reasons: returns disappointed 3, needed the money 2, market fell 2, payments kept failing 2	Returns and money needs come up more often than failed payments
C, all answers	Returns disappointed 11, needed the money 10, market fell 4, moved elsewhere 4, payments kept failing 3, someone advised 2	Disappointing returns matter more than the public posts suggested
D. Adjusts	29 of 37 know they can pause (19 have used it); 8 don't, including 3 of the 7 who stopped or paused	Pausing is known, but not to everyone who quits
Main metric	Of 35 old enough: an instalment went through around the 1-year mark for 21, not for 5, not sure 9	Many can't recall, so self-reported retention is a weak measure

What changes

- The problem statement gets a second half. Failures are frequent and sometimes noticed late (B), but stops come more often from disappointing returns and money needs (C).
- Branch B stays the most controllable, but the survey shows failures behind only some stops; the interviews test this further.

- The sample leans experienced. Only 6 of 37 started in the last 12 months, so first-timers are under-represented.

Interview picks (from the 14 who agreed to a chat; sheet row numbers, emails stay in the sheet)

Sheet row	App	Why this person	Branch
34	Zerodha	Failed instalment from a mandate problem, found out over a week later	B
27	Zerodha	Not sure if one failed; mandate problem; found out over a week later	B
2	Zerodha	Started under a month ago and already had a failure. Some answers conflict, so check them	A, B
8	Zerodha	Started 13–24 months ago, still running, no problems	Comparison
5	Other	Stopped after a failed instalment (short balance)	C, D
13	Other	Stopped, didn't know pausing existed, not active at the 1-year mark	C, D

Backups: rows 14 and 4 (Zerodha), 11 (another app, had a failure) and 7 (another app, started 4–12 months ago).